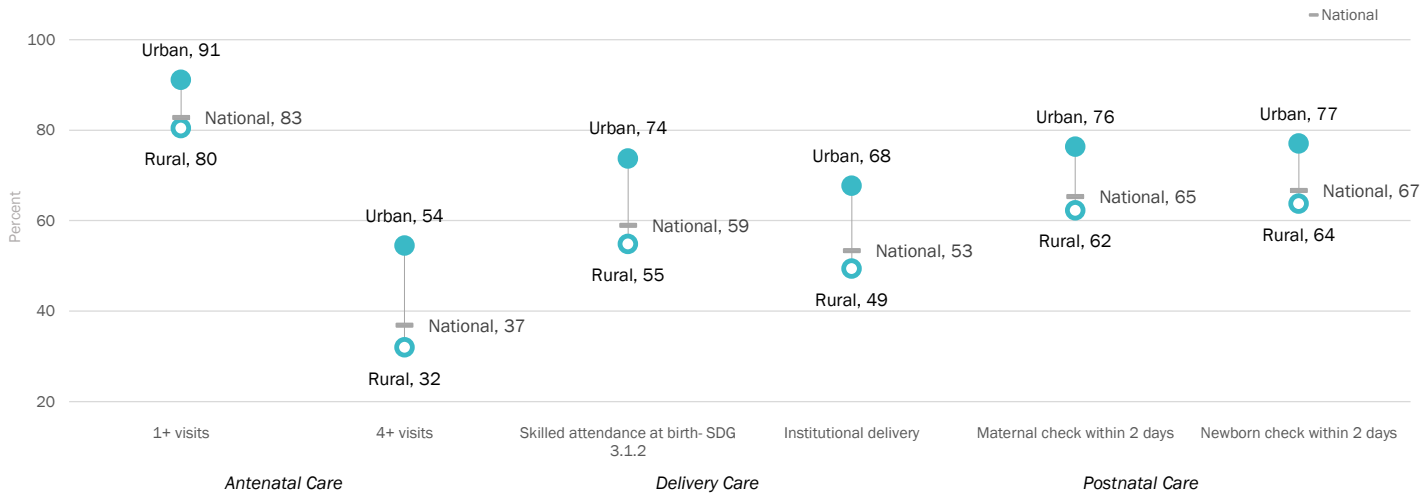
Bangladesh 2019

Maternal & Newborn Health

Multiple Indicator Cluster Surveys

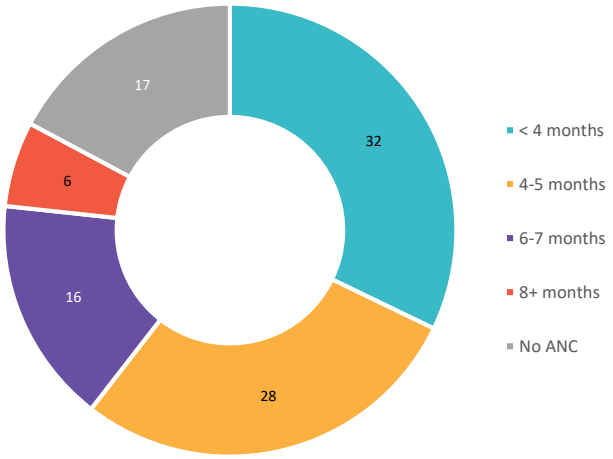
Key Elements of Maternal & Newborn Health

Maternal & Newborn Health Cascade by Area



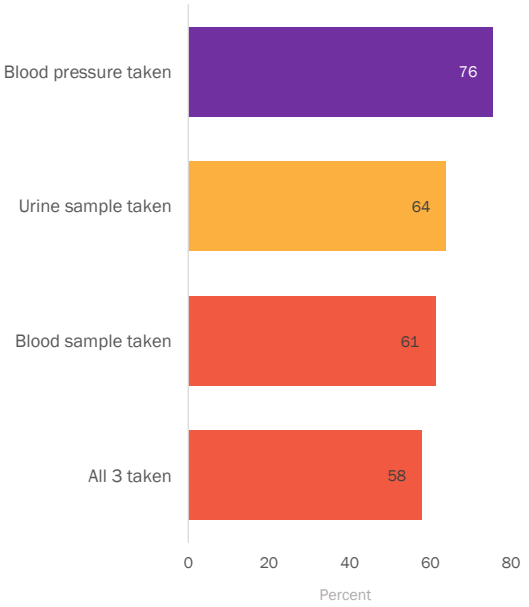
Percentage of women age 15-49 years with a live birth in the last 2 years who were attended during their last pregnancy that led to a live birth at least once by skilled health personnel or at least four times by any provider, who were attended by skilled health personnel during their most recent live birth (**SDG 3.1.2**), whose most recent live birth was delivered in a health facility, who received a health check while in facility or at home following delivery, or a post-natal care visit within 2 days after delivery of their most recent live and percentage of last live births in the last 2 years who received a health check while in facility or at home following delivery, or a post-natal care visit within 2 days after delivery, by area

Timing of First Antenatal Care Visit



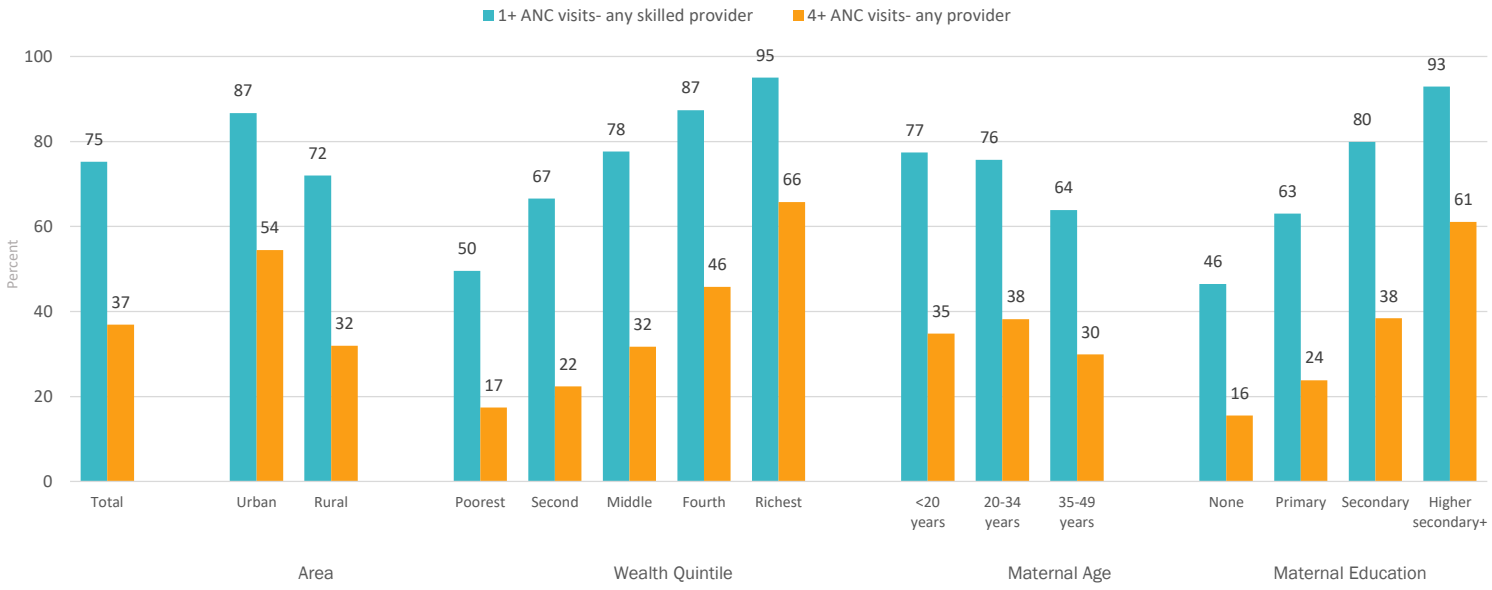
Percentage of women age 15-49 years with a live birth in the last 2 years who were attended during their last pregnancy that led to a live birth at least once by skilled health personnel, by the timing of first ANC visit

Content & Coverage of Antenatal Care Services



Percentage of women age 15-49 years with a live birth in the last 2 years who had their blood pressure measured and gave urine and blood samples.

Coverage of Antenatal Care by Various Characteristics

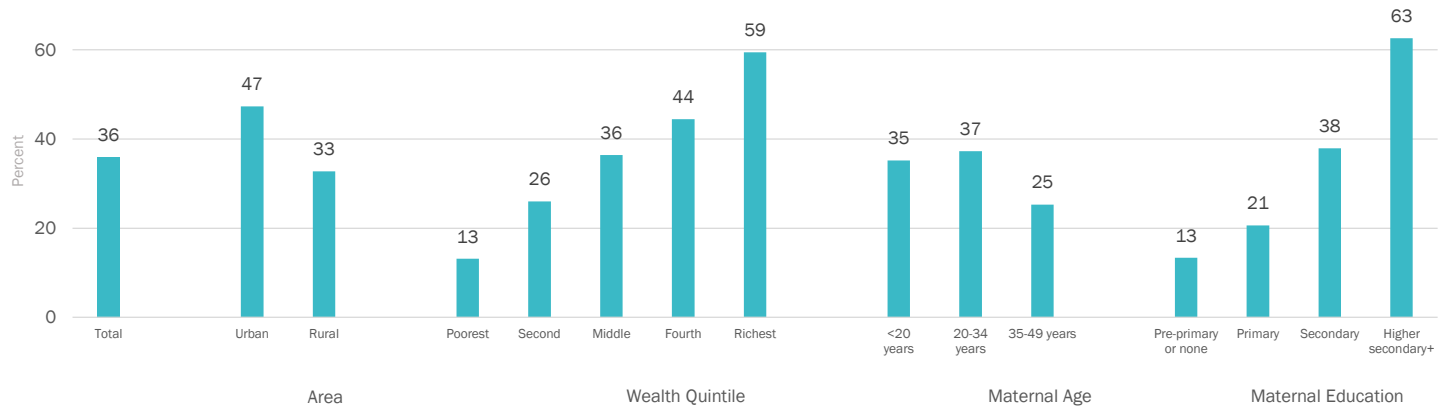


Percentage of women age 15-49 years with a live birth in the last 2 years who were attended during their last pregnancy that led to a live birth at least once by skilled health personnel or at least four times by any provider

Coverage of Skilled Attendance at Birth & Institutional Delivery by Area

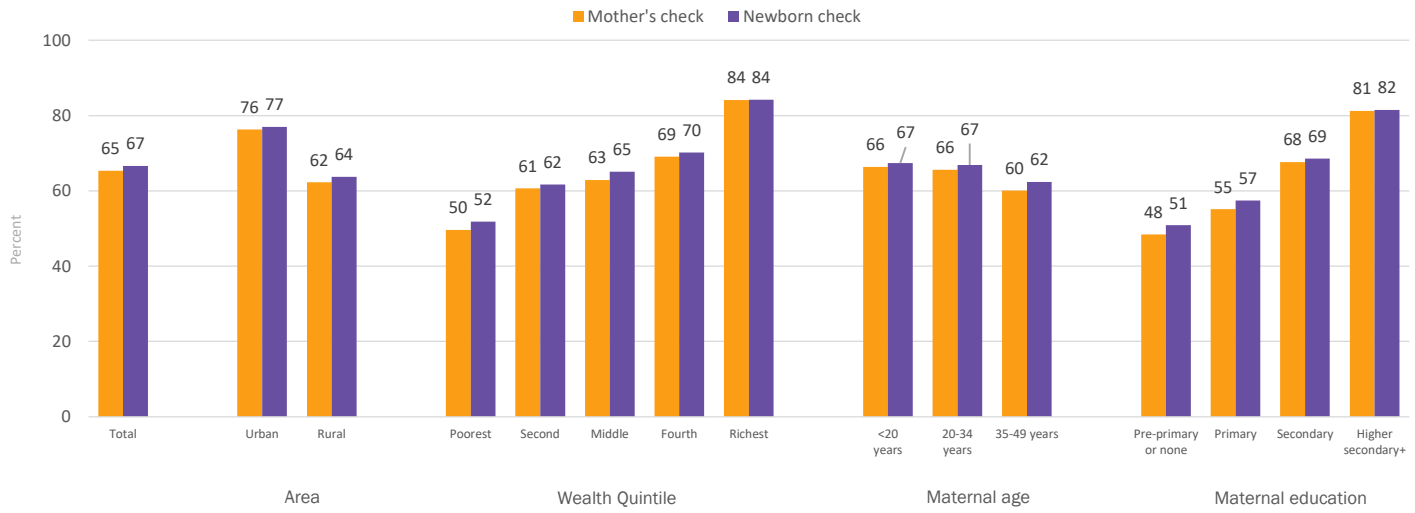
Percentage of women age 15-49 years with a live birth in the last 2 years who were attended by skilled health personnel during their most recent live birth and percentage whose most recent live birth was delivered in a health facility (institutional delivery) by area

Caesarian Section by Various Characteristics



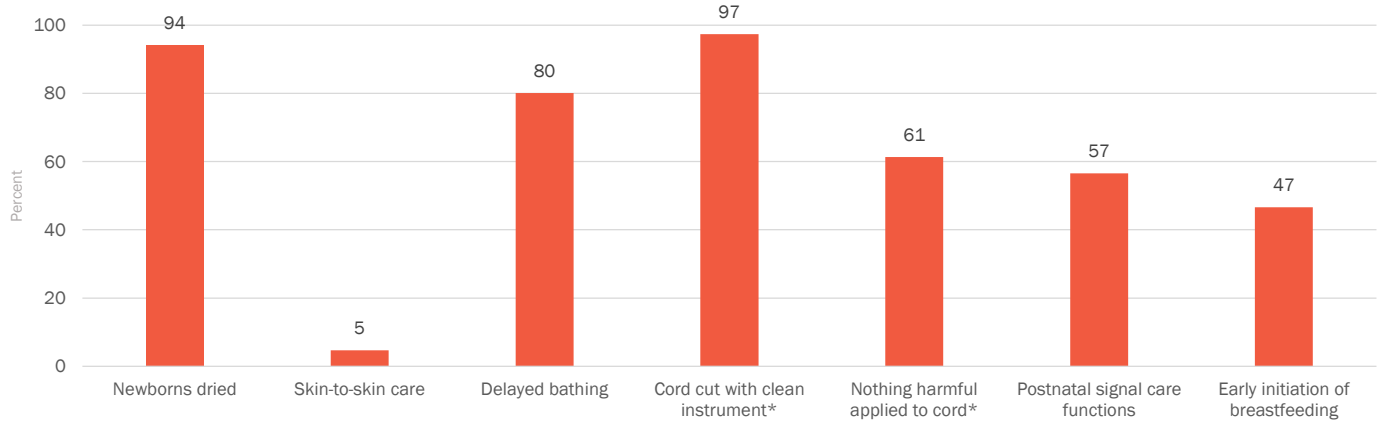
Percentage of women age 15-49 years with a live birth in the last 2 years whose most recent live birth was delivered by caesarean section by various characteristics

Postnatal Care within 2 Days of Birth by Various Characteristics



Percentage of women age 15-49 years with a live birth in the last 2 years who received a health check while in facility or at home following delivery, or a post-natal care visit within 2 days after delivery of their most recent live and percentage of last live births in the last 2 years who received a health check while in facility or at home following delivery, or a post-natal care visit within 2 days after delivery, by various characteristics

Coverage of Newborn Care



Among the last live-birth in the last 2 years, percentage who were dried after birth; percentage who were given skin to skin contact; percentage who were bathed after 24 hours of birth; percentage where the umbilical cord was cut with a new blade or boiled instrument*; percentage where nothing harmful was applied to the cord*; percentage where the newborn received a least 2 postnatal signal care functions within 2 days after birth; and percentage of women with a live birth in the last 2 years who put their last newborn to the breast within one hour of birth, by various characteristics

* Among the last live birth in the last 2 years delivered outside a facility

Divisional Data on Maternal and Newborn Cascade

Division	ANC: At least 1 visit (skilled provider)	ANC: At least 4 visits (any provider)	Skilled Attendance at Birth	Institutional Delivery	Postnatal Care for Mother <2 days	Postnatal Care for Newborn <2 days
National	**75**	**37**	**59**	**53**	**65**	**67**
Barishal	71	28	45	37	48	49
Chattogram	76	36	58	52	61	63
Dhaka	83	42	66	62	71	72
Khulna	85	47	77	71	83	84
Mymensingh	64	23	37	34	52	53
Rajshahi	73	35	61	57	58	59
Rangpur	67	39	58	50	67	67
Sylhet	63	30	48	40	73	74

For indicator definitions, see earlier charts

Key Messages

- Nationally, three-quarters (75%) of women aged 15-49 years with a live birth in the past two years received at least one ANC contact by a skilled health personnel; only 37% received at least four ANC contacts from any personnel. Most urban women (87%) received at least one ANC contact by a skilled provider and about half received at least four ANC contacts. Around three-quarters (72%) of rural women receive one ANC contact and about one-third (32%) receive at least four ANC contacts. The current WHO recommendation is that women receive eight ANC contacts during pregnancy, which increases the chances that perinatal complications will be detected. In Bangladesh, all women receive far fewer ANC contacts than are recommended.
- In Bangladesh, only 32% of women receive their first ANC contact during their first four months of pregnancy, meaning that many women in Bangladesh receive too few ANC contacts and too late.
- This MICS asked women about the content of the ANC contact they received during their most recent pregnancy in the past two years.
- Women were asked if their blood pressure was measured and if urine and blood samples were taken. Results from these questions provide a measure of the quality of care received by women during ANC contacts. About half (58%) of the women who receive ANC in Bangladesh received all three measures of quality of care (blood pressure measured, urine, and blood sample taken). While there is plenty of room for improvement, these data indicate that the health system in Bangladesh is responding to WHO standards for quality of ANC care.
- About half (49%) of rural women with a live birth in the past two years delivered in a health facility compared to 68% of urban women. Urban women were also more likely to give birth aided by a skilled attendant (74%) compared to rural women (55%). Too many women in Bangladesh give birth without a skilled provider, which is a critical intervention for safe motherhood.
- An alarming number of women in Bangladesh give birth via caesarean section. In urban areas, almost half (47%) of the women give birth via caesarean section. Birth via caesarean section increases as women become wealthier and more educated. Even in rural areas, far too many women (33%) deliver via caesarean section. There is an urgent need to understand who these women are, from whom they received delivery services, and the motivations for these caesarean deliveries. Education for women and health workers about the appropriate use of caesarean section interventions and the health risks associated with unnecessary caesarean section delivery is urgently needed. Furthermore, data on how high rates of caesarean section delivery impact other health outcomes, such as early initiation of breastfeeding need to be understood better.

The Bangladesh Multiple Indicator Cluster Survey (MICS) was carried out in 2019 by the Bangladesh Bureau of Statistics as part of the global MICS programme. Technical and financial support was also provided by the United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF).

The objective of this snapshot is to disseminate selected findings from the Bangladesh MICS 2018-2019 related to Maternal and Newborn Health. Data from this snapshot can be found in table TM.4.1, TM.4.2, TM.4.3, TM.5.1, TM.6.1, TM.6.2, TM.8.2, TM.8.4, TM.8.5, TM.8.6, TM.8.7, TM8.9 TM.11.5, TC.6.9 and TC.7.1.

Further statistical snapshots and the Survey Findings Report for this and other surveys are available on mics.unicef.org/surveys.